

Knights struggle with distant passers

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A knight's short range makes it difficult to control passed pawns far apart. A pawn near the edge also limits some knight blockade routes. However, forks and checking captures can reverse an apparently lost race.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A knight stopping an a-pawn may be too far away to catch an h-pawn. Before resigning, inspect whether a checking fork can win a pawn or whether the enemy king must abandon support to avoid it.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

How do you evaluate a knight's defensive route?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Count actual legal knight moves to blockade or capture, track square colors, and include forcing checks. Geometric distance measured in king moves does not describe a knight's travel time.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Calculate knight routes explicitly in pawn races.